Policy & Strategy Lab

Framework Library

Stage 3 of 12 · Version 1.0 · November 2026

This library documents every tool the Lab uses, and several it deliberately does not teach. Each tool has a card with the same fields: the question it answers, where it comes from, what it needs, what it produces, how to use it, an Indian example, how it is misused, what it cannot tell you, and where it sits in the course.

How to read the library

Status. *Anchor*: taught to independent use on a named day. *Supporting*: demonstrated, used selectively. *Reference*: documented here for participants whose case calls for it; not taught.

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The library at a glance

#	Tool	Origin	Status	Day
1	Problem, symptom, cause, solution sort	Lab device	Anchor	1
2	Problem Definition Canvas, with 5W1H and the narrowing ladder	Lab device; 5W1H general practice	Anchor	2
3	MECE issue tree, with the hypothesis-led tree	Minto and McKinsey practice	Anchor	3
4	Driver tree	General practice	Supporting	3, 19
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7	Fishbone diagram	Kaoru Ishikawa	Supporting	4
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12	PESTLE	Environmental scanning (Aguilar)	Supporting	6
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14	Porter's Five Forces	Michael Porter	Reference	
15	McKinsey 7S	Waterman, Peters and Phillips	Reference	

#	Tool	Origin	Status	Day
16	Power-interest map with absent voices	Mendelow, adapted	Anchor	7
17	Problem-driven political economy analysis	World Bank	Supporting	7
18	Pruning matrix	Conn and McLean	Anchor	8
19	Pareto reasoning	Pareto; Juran	Supporting	8
20	Hypothesis register and competing hypotheses	Consulting practice; Heuer	Anchor	9
21	Assumption mapping	Design and product practice	Supporting	9
22	Workplan matrix	McKinsey step four	Anchor	10
23	Evidence gap map	3ie	Reference	10
24	Source reliability assessment	Lab device	Anchor	11
25	Disaggregation analysis	General statistical practice	Anchor	12
26	Comparative case matrix	Comparative policy analysis	Anchor	13
27	Hypothesis testing matrix with claim, evidence, warrant	Toulmin; Heuer	Anchor	14
28	Pyramid Principle and SCQA	Barbara Minto	Anchor	15
29	Journey map and How Might We	Service design; IDEO	Anchor	16
30	Desirability, feasibility, viability	IDEO	Supporting	16
31	EAST	Behavioural Insights Team	Reference	16
32	Impact-effort matrix and ICE	General practice; growth practice	Supporting	16
33	Options appraisal (multi-criteria analysis)	Decision analysis	Anchor	17
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39	RAPID and RACI	Bain; project management practice	Supporting	18
40	Strategy Palette and problem-driven iterative adaptation	BCG; Andrews, Pritchett and Woolcock	Supporting	18
41	Risk register and reference-class forecasting	General practice; Flyvbjerg	Supporting	18
42	Operating model design and capabilities-driven strategy	Deloitte; Strategy& (PwC)	Reference	
43	Indicator tree with SMART indicators	General practice; Doran	Anchor	19
44	Output-Outcome Monitoring Framework	NITI Aayog (DMEO) and Ministry of Finance	Supporting	19

Where each organisation contributes

Organisation	What the Lab uses	What it does not use, and why
McKinsey & Company	Seven-step process; issue trees; pruning; workplans; Pyramid Principle (via Minto)	The 7S and Three Horizons models: useful for firms, rarely decisive for a public problem (7S kept as reference)
Boston Consulting Group	Strategy Palette, on choosing between planning and adapting	The growth-share matrix: built for business portfolios

Organisation	What the Lab uses	What it does not use, and why
Bain & Company	RAPID decision roles	Net Promoter Score and growth tools: no public analogue that adds to the course
Deloitte	Government transformation sequence (strategy, design, build, deliver, innovate) and operating model design, as reference	Not taught in depth: stage detail is general
PwC (Strategy&)	Capabilities-driven strategy, as reference for institutional capacity	Its market framing does not translate directly
KPMG	Nothing adopted	Its public material on operating models covers ground the Lab already teaches
Accenture	Public Service Value model, as reference	Too aggregate for a four-week case
IDEO and the Stanford d.school	Journey maps, How Might We, desirability-feasibility-viability	Prototyping with users: excluded by the no-primary-research rule
The Bridgespan Group	Intended impact paired with theory of change	
Behavioural Insights Team	EAST, as reference for behaviour-change options	
Public sector and development practice	Bardach's eightfold path; Moore's triangle; HM Treasury Green Book; delivery chains; problem-driven political economy analysis; PDIA; India's Output-Outcome Monitoring Framework	

Problem definition

1. Problem, symptom, cause, solution sort

Field	Content
Question it answers	Is what I am calling the problem really the problem?
Origin	Lab device, drawing on general problem-solving practice
Inputs	Statements you believe about the issue
Output	Statements sorted into four categories; a problem statement free of causes and solutions
Steps	Write five statements; sort each; rewrite the problem with the causes and solutions removed
Indian example	Welfare access: a lack of awareness is a candidate cause, not the problem; the problem is eligible households not receiving benefits
Misuses	Treating candidate causes as established; arguing about labels rather than evidence
Cannot tell you	Which causes are true
Place in the method	Step 1, define
Status	Anchor, Day 1

2. Problem Definition Canvas, with 5W1H and the narrowing ladder

Field	Content
Question it answers	Is the problem precise enough to analyse and act on?
Origin	Lab device; 5W1H is general journalistic and quality practice
Inputs	The sorted problem; at least two public sources; a decision-maker
Output	Nine boxes: group, place, institution, current and desired condition, decision-maker and decision, why it matters, out of scope, measure of success
Steps	Climb the ladder (domain, issue, problem, population, place, institution, decision); fill the boxes in order; run the statement through who, what, where, when, why and how do we know
Indian example	Madhyapur: households in residential wards hand over mixed waste contrary to the 2016 rules; the Commissioner chooses a compliance strategy
Misuses	Filling the current condition with an unsourced number; leaving out of scope empty
Cannot tell you	Whether the framing is the right one; record competing framings separately
Place in the method	Step 1, define
Status	Anchor, Day 2

Structuring

3. MECE issue tree, with the hypothesis-led tree

Field	Content
Question it answers	What are the component questions, without overlaps or gaps?

Field	Content
Origin	MECE is associated with Barbara Minto's work at McKinsey; issue trees are documented by Conn and McLean. Developed
Inputs	A precise problem stated as a question
Output	A tree to three levels ending in answerable questions; a sealed working answer
Steps	Write the root question; choose one splitting logic (stage, actor, supply and demand, formula); test level one for overlaps and gaps; build down to answerable leaves; write a hypothesis-led version and seal your best answer
Indian example	Madhyapur split by the waste chain: home, collection, processing, enforcement
Misuses	Mixing splitting logics; leaves that are solutions; a mind map presented as a tree
Cannot tell you	Which branches matter most (see 18) or which are true
Place in the method	Step 2, disaggregate
Status	Anchor, Day 3

4. Driver tree

Field	Content
Question it answers	How does an outcome break down arithmetically?
Origin	General practice in finance and consulting
Inputs	An outcome that can be expressed as a product or sum of components
Output	A tree of multiplicative or additive drivers
Steps	Express the outcome as a formula (for example coverage times uptake times use); find data for each driver; see which driver constrains the outcome
Indian example	Girls riding to school equals eligible girls times the share identified, applying, receiving and using
Misuses	Treating drivers as independent when they interact
Cannot tell you	Why a driver is low
Place in the method	Step 2; reused as the indicator tree on Day 19
Status	Supporting, Days 3 and 19

Causes and systems

5. Problem tree

Field	Content
Question it answers	Why does the problem exist, at which level?
Origin	General practice in development project planning, associated with the logical framework approach
Inputs	The core problem; candidate causes
Output	Effects above, the core problem in the middle, proximate and structural causes below, each link with a mechanism
Steps	Place the core problem; add effects; add proximate causes; add the structural causes behind them; write the mechanism on every link

Field	Content
Indian example	Madhyapur: separating seems pointless because crews mix bags (proximate) because the contract pays by weight (structural)
Misuses	Single-cause trees; arrows without mechanisms
Cannot tell you	Whether any link is true; that needs evidence
Place in the method	Step 2
Status	Anchor, Day 4

6. Five Whys

Field	Content
Question it answers	What lies behind this cause?
Origin	Toyota production system (associated with Sakichi Toyoda and Taiichi Ohno). Originated
Inputs	A problem or cause
Output	One causal chain
Steps	Ask why up to five times; check each answer against the problem tree; run a second chain from another starting point
Indian example	Households mix waste because they think it gets mixed anyway, because crews tip bags together, because the contract pays by weight
Misuses	Stopping where the analyst's beliefs stop; treating one chain as the explanation
Cannot tell you	Whether other chains matter more
Place in the method	Step 2
Status	Supporting, Day 4

7. Fishbone diagram

Field	Content
Question it answers	Have we considered causes in every category?
Origin	Kaoru Ishikawa, quality management. Originated
Inputs	An effect; a set of categories
Output	Candidate causes grouped by category
Steps	Write the effect at the head; draw five or six category bones; brainstorm causes on each; move promising ones to the problem tree
Indian example	Madhyapur: households, collection, contract, processing, enforcement, information
Misuses	Treating a brainstorm as evidence; listing without linking
Cannot tell you	Which causes matter or how they connect
Place in the method	Step 2
Status	Supporting, Day 4

8. Causal loop diagram

Field	Content
Question it answers	What keeps the problem in place?
Origin	System dynamics, from Jay Forrester's work at MIT; popularised by Peter Senge and Donella Meadows. Developed
Inputs	Causes from the problem tree
Output	One or two loops with polarities, labelled reinforcing or balancing
Steps	Pick a variable; trace what it affects until you return to it; mark each link plus or minus; count minus links (odd means balancing)
Indian example	Crews mix waste, households see it, stop separating, more mixed waste: a reinforcing loop fed by the contract
Misuses	Huge maps nobody can read; chains presented as loops
Cannot tell you	The strength of each link or the size of delays
Place in the method	Step 2
Status	Anchor, Day 5

9. Unintended consequences check

Field	Content
Question it answers	How could the obvious fix make things worse?
Origin	Lab device, drawing on Robert Merton's analysis of the unanticipated consequences of purposive action (1936)
Inputs	The obvious fix; the actors it affects
Output	At least two plausible unintended effects, each with a mechanism and who bears it
Steps	Write the intended chain; add each actor's likely response; look for responses that feed back on the problem
Indian example	Fining households that mix waste raises roadside dumping
Misuses	Listing effects without mechanisms; rejecting good policies because side effects exist
Cannot tell you	How likely each effect is
Place in the method	Steps 2 and 7
Status	Supporting, Days 5 and 16

Context and institutions

10. Delivery chain map

Field	Content
Question it answers	Through which people and institutions does policy reach the citizen, and where does it break?
Origin	Associated with Michael Barber's delivery work, including the UK Prime Minister's Delivery Unit. Developed (verify source)
Inputs	Scheme guidelines; institutional knowledge; audits
Output	Five or six links from policy-maker to citizen, with the likely break point marked
Steps	List each link; note who is responsible and what they control; ask how you would know each link works; mark the break with evidence
Indian example	Union ministry, state department, municipal corporation, ward staff, contractor crews, households: Madhyapur's break is between ward staff and crews
Misuses	Charts without evidence of where the chain fails
Cannot tell you	Why the link fails; combine with incentives (16)
Place in the method	Step 2
Status	Anchor, Day 6

11. Jurisdiction and money check

Field	Content
Question it answers	Who has the authority to act, and where does the money come from?
Origin	Lab device, from the Constitution of India (Seventh, Eleventh and Twelfth Schedules) and budget documents
Inputs	The Constitution; scheme guidelines; budget documents and analyses (PRS Legislative Research, Open Budgets India)
Output	Legislative authority, administrative control and funding route identified separately, with sources
Steps	Find the list entry or schedule item; identify who administers; trace the budget head and the sharing pattern; note the latest allocation with year and source
Indian example	Solid waste management: Twelfth Schedule, item 6; public health and sanitation and local government are State List subjects; mission and Finance Commission funding
Misuses	Treating the government as one actor; citing a budget figure without year and source
Cannot tell you	Whether funds were released and spent well
Place in the method	Step 2
Status	Supporting, Day 6

12. PESTLE

Field	Content
Question it answers	Have we missed a political, economic, social, technological, legal or environmental factor?
Origin	Grew from Francis Aguilar's environmental scanning work in the 1960s. General practice

Field	Content
Inputs	The issue tree
Output	A checked tree with any missing branch added
Steps	Ask, for each factor, whether the tree has a branch for it; add a branch only if the factor would change the analysis
Indian example	Madhyapur: political (councillors and ward elections) and social (stigma of waste work)
Misuses	Writing six paragraphs instead of an argument
Cannot tell you	Anything causal
Place in the method	Step 2
Status	Supporting, Day 6 (as a checklist)

13. SWOT

Field	Content
Question it answers	What are an organisation's strengths, weaknesses, opportunities and threats?
Origin	Contested; often linked to 1960s business-school and research institute work. Do not attribute to a single author
Inputs	Knowledge of one organisation
Output	A four-box summary
When to use it	Only when the client is an organisation assessing its own capacity, such as a municipal corporation weighing whether it can run a new service
Misuses	Using it to analyse a problem rather than an organisation; lists without priorities
Cannot tell you	Causes, priorities or what to do
Status	Reference

14. Porter's Five Forces

Field	Content
Question it answers	How attractive and competitive is an industry?
Origin	Michael Porter, Harvard Business Review, 1979. Originated
When to use it	Rarely in this course: for regulated markets with private providers, such as private schools or bus operators
Misuses	Applying market logic to welfare services
Status	Reference

15. McKinsey 7S

Field	Content
Question it answers	Are an organisation's strategy, structure, systems, shared values, style, staff and skills aligned?
Origin	Waterman, Peters and Phillips (1980), at McKinsey. Originated
When to use it	When the problem is an implementing organisation's capacity, for example a state agency taking on a new mission

Field	Content
Misuses	Using it as a checklist without evidence
Status	Reference

Actors and political economy

16. Power-interest map with absent voices

Field	Content
Question it answers	Who shapes the outcome, what do they want, and who is not heard?
Origin	The power-interest grid is commonly attributed to Aubrey Mendelow (1991) (verify). The absent-voices quadrant and incentive columns are Lab adaptations
Inputs	The delivery chain; actors affected
Output	A map with every key actor placed; an incentive matrix (what they want, what the system rewards, likely response)
Steps	List actors; rate power and interest; place them; for key actors, write incentives and likely responses; name the absent voices
Indian example	Madhyapur: the Commissioner, councillors and contractor manage closely; waste pickers and residents near the landfill are absent voices
Misuses	Explaining behaviour by attitudes; managing only the powerful
Cannot tell you	How actors will actually behave under a new design; test against evidence
Place in the method	Step 2
Status	Anchor, Day 7

17. Problem-driven political economy analysis

Field	Content
Question it answers	Why do the institutions and incentives around this problem produce the outcomes they do, and what change is feasible?
Origin	World Bank good-practice framework (Fritz, Kaiser and Levy, 2009). Developed
Inputs	Actor map; history of reform attempts; rules in use
Output	Four answers: who gains from the status quo, who would lose and can block, who would gain but is unorganised, what would make change feasible
Indian example	Madhyapur's contractor gains from payment by weight and could litigate or slow collection
Misuses	Cynicism: treating feasibility as a reason to recommend nothing
Cannot tell you	What is desirable; only what is feasible
Status	Supporting, Day 7

Prioritisation

18. Pruning matrix

Field	Content
Question it answers	Which branches deserve limited research time?
Origin	Described by Conn and McLean as pruning the tree. Developed (verify the axes against the book)
Inputs	The issue tree
Output	Branches rated by size of effect and ability to influence; two or three priorities; reasons for every cut
Steps	Rate each branch with a reason; place it on the matrix; choose priorities; check you have not pruned a small group bearing a large harm
Indian example	Madhyapur: collection and processing first; national recycling prices pruned to context
Misuses	Pruning by convenience; using intervention-ranking tools to rank issues
Cannot tell you	Whether the ratings are right; they are hypotheses
Place in the method	Step 3
Status	Anchor, Day 8

19. Pareto reasoning

Field	Content
Question it answers	Does a small share of causes account for most of the effect?
Origin	Named after Vilfredo Pareto; popularised in quality management by Joseph Juran
Use	As a search strategy: look for concentration, then measure it
Misuses	Assuming the split is 80/20; dropping small groups with large harms
Status	Supporting, Day 8

Hypotheses

20. Hypothesis register and competing hypotheses

Field	Content
Question it answers	What do we believe, and what would prove it wrong?
Origin	Hypothesis-driven consulting practice; the discipline of seeking evidence that discriminates between hypotheses comes from Richards Heuer's analysis of competing hypotheses (1999). Developed
Inputs	Priority branches
Output	Three to five falsifiable hypotheses, each with disconfirming evidence, a rival and a confidence rating
Steps	State each as a comparison; write the disconfirming test first; add a rival and the evidence that would distinguish them
Indian example	Madhyapur H1: payment by weight leads crews to mix waste; rival: vehicles lack compartments

Field	Content
Misuses	Untestable hypotheses; looking only for support
Cannot tell you	The answer; it organises the search for one
Place in the method	Steps 3 and 4
Status	Anchor, Day 9

21. Assumption mapping

Field	Content
Question it answers	Which beliefs should we test first?
Origin	Design and product practice, popularised in books on testing business ideas (verify)
Output	Assumptions placed by importance and evidence; the important and uncertain tested first
Misuses	Mapping without then testing
Status	Supporting, Day 9

Research and evidence

22. Workplan matrix

Field	Content
Question it answers	What analysis, from which source, by when?
Origin	Step four of the seven-step process. Developed
Inputs	The hypothesis register
Output	A row per priority hypothesis: research question, analysis, named source, deadline
Steps	Order rows by which analysis could most change the answer; check each source for level, period and access
Indian example	Madhyapur H1: compare cities with different payment terms using published contracts and case studies
Misuses	Rows that name government data rather than a specific source
Status	Anchor, Day 10

23. Evidence gap map

Field	Content
Question it answers	Where is evidence on interventions and outcomes plentiful, and where is it missing?
Origin	The International Initiative for Impact Evaluation (3ie) and others. Developed
Use	Consult an existing map for your sector before designing your workplan
Status	Reference

24. Source reliability assessment

Field	Content
Question it answers	How far can this source be trusted, for this question?
Origin	Lab device, drawing on evidence-assessment practice
Inputs	Each source
Output	Producer, method, period, level, coverage and limits recorded; a reliability rating with a reason
Steps	Ask the five questions: who produced it and why; how; when and for which period; at what level; what it leaves out
Indian example	Ward returns are self-reported by staff judged on them: low to medium reliability
Misuses	Rating by reputation alone
Status	Anchor, Day 11

25. Disaggregation analysis

Field	Content
Question it answers	Where does the problem concentrate?
Origin	General statistical practice
Output	Charts or tables by place, group or time, with interpretation and limits
Steps	Compute the aggregate; break it down; check denominators, missing data and changes in counting; title each chart with its finding
Indian example	Madhyapur's average rose mainly because planned colonies improved; informal settlements barely reported
Misuses	Reporting averages; points and per cent confused; causal language from patterns
Status	Anchor, Day 12

26. Comparative case matrix

Field	Content
Question it answers	What can we learn from places that tackled a similar problem?
Origin	Comparative policy analysis; the policy transfer literature (Dolowitz and Marsh, 2000)
Output	For each comparison place: what was done, what helped, evidence of results, what transfers
Indian example	Indore, Pune and Ambikapur's routes to separated collection, each under particular conditions (verify descriptions)
Misuses	Copying forms without functions; treating fame as proof
Status	Anchor, Day 13

27. Hypothesis testing matrix, with claim, evidence and warrant

Field	Content
Question it answers	Which explanations survive the evidence?
Origin	Heuer's competing hypotheses; Stephen Toulmin's model of argument (1958)

Field	Content
Output	Supporting and disconfirming evidence per hypothesis; a verdict (supported, weakened, unresolved) and confidence; the strongest finding as claim, evidence and warrant
Indian example	Madhyapur: containers weakened; contract supported with the vehicle rival partly true
Misuses	Counting supporting sources; missing warrants
Status	Anchor, Day 14

Communication

28. Pyramid Principle and SCQA

Field	Content
Question it answers	How do we turn findings into an argument a decision-maker can use?
Origin	Barbara Minto, developed at McKinsey. Originated
Output	A governing message; three non-overlapping key lines; supporting evidence; an introduction in Situation, Complication, Question, Answer form
Steps	Write the answer first; group support into MECE key lines; write the SCQA opening; end with the decision required
Indian example	Separation fails mainly at collection, because the contract pays for weight
Misuses	Topic headings instead of claims; conclusions buried
Status	Anchor, Day 15; used again on Day 19 for argument titles

Designing options

29. Journey map and How Might We

Field	Content
Question it answers	Where does the citizen's experience break, and what question would open up options there?
Origin	Service design and human-centred design practice, popularised by IDEO; How Might We is traced in some accounts to earlier innovation practice at Procter & Gamble (verify)
Inputs	Published evidence on people's experience (no primary research in this course)
Output	A journey with break points; a How Might We question for each break; options that differ in mechanism
Indian example	Madhyapur household: no space for a second bin; unpredictable collection; crews mix the streams
Misuses	Journeys invented without evidence; questions that contain a solution
Status	Anchor, Day 16

30. Desirability, feasibility, viability

Field	Content
Question it answers	Would people want it, can it be done, can it be sustained?
Origin	IDEO's design practice. Popularised
Note	Public policy adds legitimacy and support (see 35)
Status	Supporting, Day 16

31. EAST

Field	Content
Question it answers	How can an option make the desired behaviour easier to adopt?
Origin	The Behavioural Insights Team, published 2014: make it Easy, Attractive, Social and Timely. Originated
Indian example	Madhyapur: two-compartment collection at a fixed time (easy, timely); ward-level feedback on separation (social)
Misuses	Nudges in place of structural change when the cause is structural
Status	Reference, for Day 16

32. Impact-effort matrix and ICE

Field	Content
Question it answers	Roughly, which interventions look worth appraising?
Origin	General practice; ICE (impact, confidence, ease) comes from growth practice in technology firms
Use	A quick screen of interventions on Day 16; never to rank issues, and never in place of the appraisal
Status	Supporting, Day 16

Choosing

33. Options appraisal (multi-criteria analysis)

Field	Content
Question it answers	Which option is best against explicit, weighted criteria?
Origin	Multi-criteria decision analysis; government manuals such as the UK's multi-criteria analysis manual (verify edition)
Inputs	Options and a baseline; evidence for each criterion
Output	A matrix of reasoned scores and weights, including distribution; a ranking with its sensitivity
Steps	Choose criteria and argue weights; score every option and the baseline with reasons; compute weighted scores; vary weights and assumptions
Indian example	Madhyapur: the pickers' partnership ranks first; the baseline second, a warning about weights
Misuses	Unexplained scores; hidden weights; treating the score as the decision
Status	Anchor, Day 17

34. Cost per outcome

Field	Content
Question it answers	Roughly what does each unit of improvement cost?
Origin	Cost-effectiveness analysis. General practice
Steps	Estimate cost and outcome for each option; state the assumption that drives each; round honestly
Indian example	Madhyapur option B: about Rs 860 per extra household separating (illustrative)
Status	Supporting, Day 17

35. Strategic triangle

Field	Content
Question it answers	Does the option create public value, command legitimacy and support, and have the capacity to deliver?
Origin	Mark Moore, Creating Public Value (1995). Originated
Use	The final test of the preferred option; name the weakest leg and strengthen it
Status	Supporting, Day 17

36. HM Treasury Green Book: cost-benefit analysis and the Five Case Model

Field	Content
Question it answers	Is a public spending proposal good value, and is the full case for it made?
Origin	HM Treasury guidance on appraisal and evaluation; the Five Case Model sets out strategic, economic, commercial, financial and management cases. Originated (check the current edition)
When to use it	For large capital or programme proposals with data to monetise benefits; beyond the scope of four weeks, but a useful checklist for the report
Status	Reference

37. Public Service Value model

Field	Content
Question it answers	Is a public agency improving outcomes relative to cost over time?
Origin	Accenture; set out by Martin Cole and Greg Parston in Unlocking Public Value (2006). Originated
Use	For comparing agencies or years, not for choosing between options in one case
Status	Reference

Delivery

38. Theory of change and logic model

Field	Content
Question it answers	How exactly is the intervention supposed to produce the outcome, and which links are assumptions?
Origin	Theory-based evaluation (Carol Weiss, 1995, and the Aspen Institute's work on community initiatives); intended impact paired with theory of change by the Bridgespan Group (Colby, Stone and Carttar, 2004). Logic models are general evaluation practice
Output	Inputs, activities, outputs, intermediate and final outcomes, with each link marked evidenced or assumed
Indian example	Madhyapur option B: the key assumption is that households will separate more once they see separation respected
Misuses	Flowcharts without assumptions
Status	Anchor, Day 18

39. RAPID and RACI

Field	Content
Question it answers	Who decides, who must agree, who does the work?
Origin	RAPID: Rogers and Blenko at Bain & Company (2006), a registered trademark. RACI: general project management practice
Output	Named roles for the key decision (Recommend, Agree, Perform, Input, Decide) or for activities (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed)
Indian example	Madhyapur: the Commissioner decides, finance and legal must agree, the cooperative and crews perform
Misuses	Writing the government; leaving activities without an accountable owner
Status	Supporting, Day 18

40. Strategy Palette and problem-driven iterative adaptation

Field	Content
Question it answers	Should we plan in full or build as we learn?
Origin	BCG's Strategy Palette (Reeves, Haanaes and Sinha, 2015): classical, adaptive, visionary, shaping and renewal approaches. Problem-driven iterative adaptation (Andrews, Pritchett and Woolcock, 2017)
Use	Plan in full when the context is predictable, capability exists and mistakes are costly; adapt when the context is uncertain and capability must be built
Indian example	Madhyapur: a ten-ward pilot reviewed quarterly
Status	Supporting, Day 18

41. Risk register and reference-class forecasting

Field	Content
Question it answers	What could go wrong, how likely is it, and who owns the response?

Field	Content
Origin	General practice; reference-class forecasting from Bent Flyvbjerg's work on large projects
Output	At least five risks across political, administrative, financial, frontline and distributional types, with likelihood, impact, owner and mitigation
Use	Check estimates against what happened to similar efforts elsewhere
Status	Supporting, Day 18

42. Operating model design and capabilities-driven strategy

Field	Content
Question it answers	What organisation, processes and capabilities does a strategy need?
Origin	Operating model design is general consulting practice, including Deloitte's government transformation sequence (strategy, design, build, deliver, innovate). Capabilities-driven strategy: Leinwand and Mainardi, The Essential Advantage (2011), at Strategy&, now part of PwC
When to use it	When the recommendation requires a new unit or major restructuring
Status	Reference

Measurement

43. Indicator tree with SMART indicators

Field	Content
Question it answers	How would anyone know the recommendation is working?
Origin	General practice; SMART criteria are usually traced to George Doran (1981)
Output	An outcome at the root, conditions as branches, measurable indicators as leaves, each with type, source, baseline and frequency, and at least one disaggregated
Indian example	Madhyapur: households separating by ward type, reported separately for informal settlements
Misuses	Output-only indicators; targets without baselines
Status	Anchor, Day 19

44. Output-Outcome Monitoring Framework

Field	Content
Question it answers	How does the Government of India monitor its own schemes' outputs and outcomes?
Origin	The Ministry of Finance with NITI Aayog's Development Monitoring and Evaluation Office; from 2026-27 the Outcome Budget is presented as the Output Outcome Monitoring Framework, covering central sector and centrally sponsored schemes above a size threshold (verify current details)
Use	Compare your indicators with the official ones for your scheme; note where they measure outputs only
Status	Supporting, Day 19